Practice workbook · Writing down the asymptotes of a rational curve

Writing down the vertical and horizontal asymptotes of a curve $y = (ax + b)/(cx + d)$.

19 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 18 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

OLevels.com SCHOOL

Type ID: FPM-GRA-04

1. Question 3 · part d · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part d only.

3

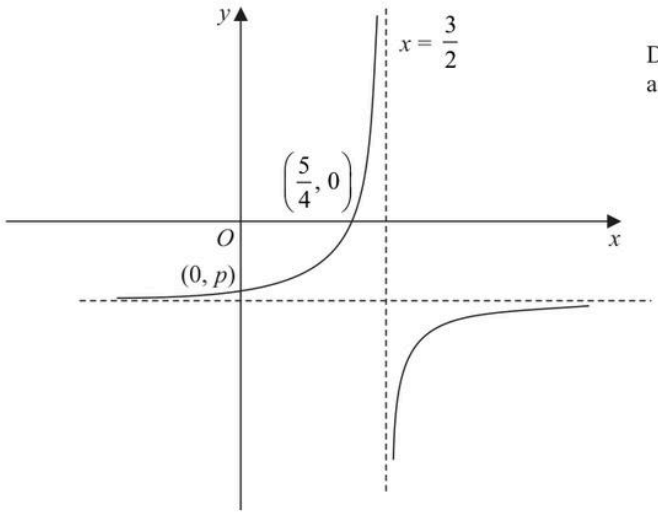


Diagram **NOT** accurately drawn

Figure 1

Figure 1 shows a sketch of the curve with equation

$$y = \frac{a - bx}{cx - d} \qquad x \neq \frac{d}{c}$$

where a, c and d are prime numbers and b is an integer.

The asymptote to the curve that is parallel to the y-axis has equation $x = \frac{3}{2}$

(a) Write down the value of c and the value of d

(2)

The curve crosses the x-axis at the point $\left(\frac{5}{4}, 0\right)$

(b) Find the value of a and the value of b

(2)

The curve crosses the y-axis at the point $(0, p)$ where p is a rational number.

(c) Find the value of p

(2)

(d) Find an equation of the asymptote to the curve that is parallel to the x-axis.

(1)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

8

P 6 6 0 2 7 R R A 0 8 3 6

1. Question 3 · part d · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part d only.

Question 3 continued

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

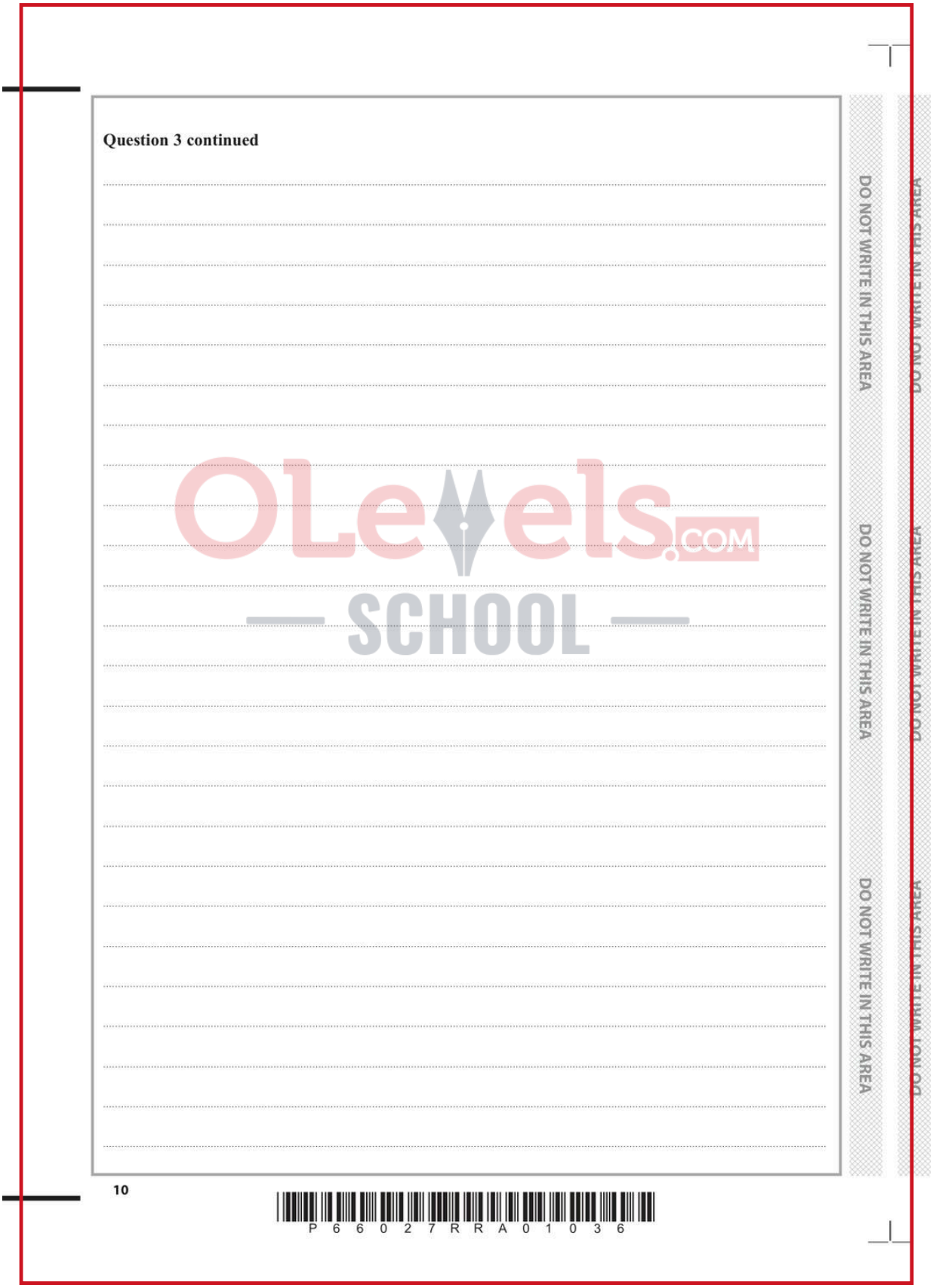
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.com SCHOOL

1. Question 3 · part d · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part d only.



Question 3 continued

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

10

P 6 6 0 2 7 R R A 0 1 0 3 6

1. Question 3 · part d · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part d only.

Question 3 continued

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.com SCHOOL

(Total for Question 3 is 7 marks)

1. Question 3 · part d · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

2. Question 3 · part b · 1 mark

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

3 Curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{ax + 3}{1 - 2x}$ where $x \neq \dfrac{1}{2}$ and a is a constant.

The asymptote to C that is parallel to the x-axis has equation $y = 4$

(a) Find the value of a

(2)

(b) Write down the equation of the asymptote to C that is parallel to the y-axis.

(1)

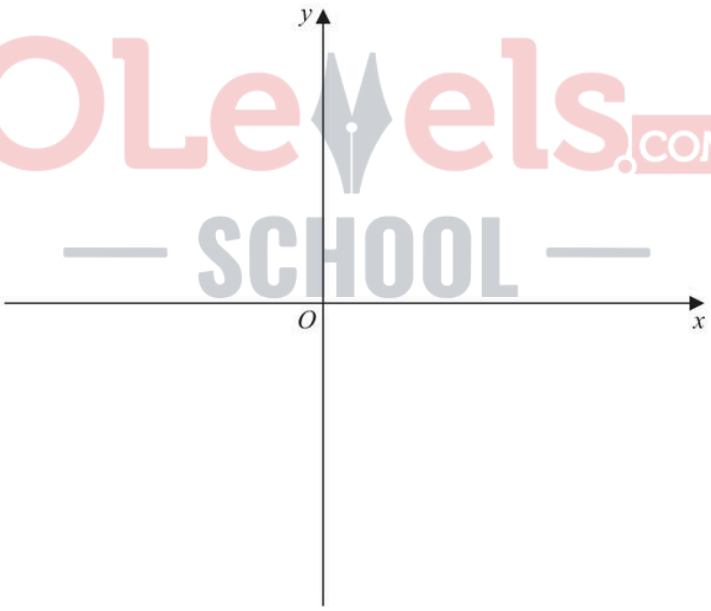
(c) Find the coordinates of the point where C crosses

(i) the x-axis, (ii) the y-axis.

(2)

(d) Using the axes below, sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(4)



DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

P 7 1 8 1 7 A 0 8 3 2

2. Question 3 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

3. Question 10 · part a.i · 0 marks

2022 JAN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a.i only.

10 The curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{2x-1}{x+4}$ $\quad x \neq -4$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the x-axis,

(ii) parallel to the y-axis.

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(2)

(c) Using the axes on the opposite page, sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(3)

The line with equation $y = x + k_1$ is the tangent to C at the point P

The line with equation $y = x + k_2$ is the tangent to C at the point Q

Given that the x coordinate of P is greater than the x coordinate of Q

(d) using calculus, find the coordinates of

(i) P

(ii) Q

(8)

(e) Hence find the value of

(i) k_1

(ii) k_2

(3)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

3. Question 10 · part a.i · 0 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

4. Question 10 · part a.ii · 2 marks

2022 JAN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a.ii only.

10 The curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{2x-1}{x+4}$ $\quad x \neq -4$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the x-axis,

(ii) parallel to the y-axis.

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(2)

(c) Using the axes on the opposite page, sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(3)

The line with equation $y = x + k_1$ is the tangent to C at the point P

The line with equation $y = x + k_2$ is the tangent to C at the point Q

Given that the x coordinate of P is greater than the x coordinate of Q

(d) using calculus, find the coordinates of

(i) P

(ii) Q

(8)

(e) Hence find the value of

(i) k_1

(ii) k_2

(3)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

4. Question 10 · part a.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

5. Question 10 · part a.i · 0 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a.i only.

10 A curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{7-x}{2x+3} \qquad x \neq -\frac{3}{2}$$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the y-axis

(ii) parallel to the x-axis

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(2)

(c) Using the axes on the opposite page, sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

C passes through the point A with coordinates $\left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{13}{8}\right)$

(d) Show that the gradient of C at A is $-\frac{17}{16}$

(3)

C also passes through the point P

Given that the tangent to C at P is parallel to the tangent to C at A

(e) find an equation of the tangent to C at P
Give your answer in the form $ax + by + c = 0$ where a, b and c are integers.

(7)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.com — SCHOOL —

5. Question 10 · part a.i · 0 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

6. Question 10 · part a.ii · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a.ii only.

10 A curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{7-x}{2x+3} \qquad x \neq -\frac{3}{2}$$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the y-axis

(ii) parallel to the x-axis

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(2)

(c) Using the axes on the opposite page, sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

C passes through the point A with coordinates $\left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{13}{8}\right)$

(d) Show that the gradient of C at A is $-\frac{17}{16}$

(3)

C also passes through the point P

Given that the tangent to C at P is parallel to the tangent to C at A

(e) find an equation of the tangent to C at P
Give your answer in the form $ax + by + c = 0$ where a, b and c are integers.

(7)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

6. Question 10 · part a.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

7. Question 3 · part b.i · 0 marks

2021 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b.i only.

3 A curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{ax - 3}{x + 5}$ where a is a constant and $x \neq -5$

The gradient of C at the point on the curve where $x = 2$ is $\dfrac{18}{49}$

(a) Show that $a = 3$

(3)

Hence

(b) write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the x-axis,

(ii) parallel to the y-axis,

(2)

(c) find the coordinates of the point where C crosses

(i) the x-axis,

(ii) the y-axis.

(2)

(d) Sketch the curve C, showing clearly its asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.com SCHOOL

7. Question 3 · part b.i · 0 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

8. Question 3 · part b.ii · 2 marks

2021 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b.ii only.

3 A curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{ax - 3}{x + 5}$ where a is a constant and $x \neq -5$

The gradient of C at the point on the curve where $x = 2$ is $\dfrac{18}{49}$

(a) Show that $a = 3$

(3)

Hence

(b) write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the x-axis,

(ii) parallel to the y-axis,

(2)

(c) find the coordinates of the point where C crosses

(i) the x-axis,

(ii) the y-axis.

(2)

(d) Sketch the curve C, showing clearly its asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.com SCHOOL

8. Question 3 · part b.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

9. Question 7 · part a · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

7

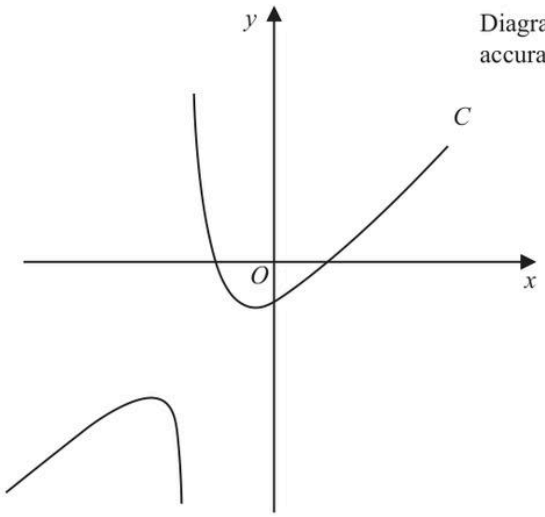


Diagram **NOT** accurately drawn

Figure 2

Figure 2 shows a sketch of part of the curve C with equation

$$y = \frac{x^2 - 1}{4x + 5} \quad \text{where} \quad x \neq -\frac{5}{4}$$

(a) Write down the equation of the asymptote to C that is parallel to the y-axis.

(1)

The line l is the normal to C at the point where $x = -1$

(b) Find an equation of l

(7)

The line l meets C again at the point D

(c) Find the coordinates of D

(6)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

14

P 7 4 2 8 5 R A 0 1 4 3 2

9. Question 7 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

10. Question 3 · part a.i · 3 marks

2025 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a.i only.

3 Curve S has equation $y = 2 - \frac{5}{2x+1}$ where $x \neq -\frac{1}{2}$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to S that is parallel to

(i) the y-axis (ii) the x-axis

(3)

(b) Find the coordinates of the point where S crosses

(i) the y-axis (ii) the x-axis

(2)

(c) Using the axes on the page opposite, sketch S, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where S crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

10. Question 3 · part a.i · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

11. Question 11 · part a.i · 0 marks

2020 JAN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a.i only.

11 The curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{3x - 2}{x + 1}$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C which is parallel to the

(i) x-axis (ii) y-axis

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the point where C crosses the

(i) x-axis (ii) y-axis

(2)

(c) Sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

The straight line l has equation $y = mx + 4$

Given that there are **no** points of intersection between l and C,

(d) show algebraically that the range of possible values of m can be written as

$$a - 2\sqrt{b} < m < a + 2\sqrt{b}$$

where a and b are integers whose values need to be found.

(7)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

P 6 0 4 7 6 A 0 3 6 4 0

11. Question 11 · part a.i · 0 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

12. Question 11 · part a.ii · 2 marks

2020 JAN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a.ii only.

11 The curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{3x - 2}{x + 1}$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C which is parallel to the

(i) x-axis (ii) y-axis

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the point where C crosses the

(i) x-axis (ii) y-axis

(2)

(c) Sketch C, showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

The straight line l has equation $y = mx + 4$

Given that there are **no** points of intersection between l and C,

(d) show algebraically that the range of possible values of m can be written as

$$a - 2\sqrt{b} < m < a + 2\sqrt{b}$$

where a and b are integers whose values need to be found.

(7)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

12. Question 11 · part a.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

13. Question 10 · part a.i · 0 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a.i only.

10 A curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{7x - 2}{2x - 3} \qquad x \neq \frac{3}{2}$$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the y-axis,

(ii) parallel to the x-axis.

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(2)

(c) Using calculus, show that at every point on the curve, the gradient of C is negative.

(4)

(d) Using the axes on the opposite page, sketch C.
Show clearly and label with their equation any asymptotes and the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(3)

The straight line l is the normal to C at the point A.
The x coordinate of A is positive and the gradient of l is 17
The line l also intersects C at the point B.

(e) Find the exact coordinates of B.

(7)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

13. Question 10 · part a.i · 0 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

14. Question 10 · part a.ii · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a.ii only.

10 A curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{7x - 2}{2x - 3} \qquad x \neq \frac{3}{2}$$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the y-axis,

(ii) parallel to the x-axis.

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(2)

(c) Using calculus, show that at every point on the curve, the gradient of C is negative.

(4)

(d) Using the axes on the opposite page, sketch C.
Show clearly and label with their equation any asymptotes and the coordinates of the points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes.

(3)

The straight line l is the normal to C at the point A.
The x coordinate of A is positive and the gradient of l is 17
The line l also intersects C at the point B.

(e) Find the exact coordinates of B.

(7)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

14. Question 10 · part a.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

15. Question 9 · part a.i · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a.i only.

9 A curve C has equation $y = \dfrac{3 - 2x}{x + 6}$ where $x \neq -6$

(a) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is parallel to the

(i) x-axis (ii) y-axis

(2)

(b) Find the coordinates of the point where C crosses the

(i) x-axis (ii) y-axis

(2)

(c) Using the axes opposite, sketch the graph of C, showing clearly its asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

(d) Show that the gradient of the tangent to C is always negative.

(3)

A tangent to C has equation $y = -\dfrac{3}{5}x + k$ where $k > 0$

(e) Find the value of k

(5)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM — SCHOOL —

15. Question 9 · part a.i · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

16. Question 10 · part b · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

10 The curve C with equation $y = \dfrac{6 - 3x}{x - 4}$ where $x \neq 4$, crosses the x-axis at the point P and the y-axis at the point Q

(a) Find the coordinates of

(i) P (ii) Q

(2)

(b) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C which is

(i) parallel to the y-axis (ii) parallel to the x-axis

(2)

(c) Sketch C showing clearly the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points P and Q

(3)

The line L is the normal to C at the point on C where $x = 2$

(d) Find an equation of L

(6)

The line L intersects C again at the point R

(e) Find the x coordinate of R

(3)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.com SCHOOL

16. Question 10 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

17. Question 10 · part b.i · 0 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b.i only.

10 A curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{5x-2}{3x+2} \qquad x \neq -\frac{2}{3}$$

(a) Find the coordinates of the point where C intersects the

(i) x-axis
(ii) y-axis

(2)

(b) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) parallel to the x-axis
(ii) parallel to the y-axis

(2)

(c) Sketch C on the opposite page.
Show and label the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

Point A lies on C such that the gradient of C at A is parallel to the line with equation $4y - x = 7$

The normal to C at A intersects the x-axis at point D and the y-axis at point E
Given that the x coordinate of A is positive,

(d) find, in its simplified form, the exact length of line DE

(11)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

17. Question 10 · part b.i · 0 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

18. Question 10 · part b.ii · 2 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b.ii only.

10 A curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{5x-2}{3x+2} \qquad x \neq -\frac{2}{3}$$

(a) Find the coordinates of the point where C intersects the

(i) x-axis
(ii) y-axis

(2)

(b) Write down an equation of the asymptote to C that is

(i) ~~parallel to the x-axis~~
(ii) parallel to the y-axis

(2)

(c) Sketch C on the opposite page.
Show and label the asymptotes and the coordinates of the points where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

Point A lies on C such that the gradient of C at A is parallel to the line with equation $4y - x = 7$

The normal to C at A intersects the x-axis at point D and the y-axis at point E
Given that the x coordinate of A is positive,

(d) find, in its simplified form, the exact length of line DE

(11)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

P 7 3 5 8 7 A 0 2 8 3 2

18. Question 10 · part b.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

19. Question 10 · part b · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

10 The curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{5x-2}{ax+b} \qquad x \neq -\frac{b}{a}$$

The asymptote to C that is parallel to the y-axis has equation $x = -\frac{4}{3}$

C crosses the y-axis at the point with coordinates $\left(0, -\frac{1}{4}\right)$

(a) (i) Show that $b = 8$

(ii) Find the value of a

(3)

(b) Write down the equation of the asymptote to C that is parallel to the x-axis.

(1)

(c) Find the coordinates of the point where C crosses the x-axis.

(1)

(d) Using calculus, show that at every point on C, the gradient is positive.

(4)

(e) Using the axes on the next page, sketch C
Clearly label the asymptotes and the coordinates where C crosses the coordinate axes.

(3)

The gradient of C is $\frac{13}{100}$ at the point E and at the point F

(f) Find the length of the line EF, giving your answer to 2 decimal places.

(6)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

P 7 6 5 0 9 A 0 2 6 3 2

19. Question 10 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL